| | |
|---|---|
| COURSE NAME | : BANKING AND BACK OFFICE OPERATION |
| GROUP NUMBER | : 7 |
| PROJECT TITLE | : A STUDY ON MUTUAL FUND TRANSACTIONS THROUGH SPECIAL REFERENCE TO NIFTY 50 |
| PROJECT SUBMITTED | : NAAN MUDHALVAN – BHARATHIDASAN UNIVERSITY |
| COLLEGE NAME | : BON SECOURS COLLEGE FOR WOMEN, THANJAVUR. |
| YEAR | : 2024-2025 |
| DEPARTMENT | : COMMERCE |
| SEMESTER | : 4 |
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# CHAPTER 1
# INTRODUCTION

# INTRODUCTION

## 1.1 Meaning of Mutual Fund

A mutual fund is an investment scheme that collects money from many investors and invests the pooled money in different securities such as equity shares, bonds, government securities and money-market instruments.

The fund is professionally managed according to its investment objective. Mutual funds help investors access financial markets through a diversified portfolio.

Investor → Pooled Money → Mutual Fund → Securities → Returns

## 1.2 Concept of Pooled Money

Pooling is the basic concept of a mutual fund. Money contributed by different investors is combined into a common fund and invested in various securities.

This allows investors to participate in a diversified investment portfolio without directly managing each security themselves.

## 1.3 Importance of Mutual Funds

**Mutual funds are an important investment avenue because they provide:**

- **Diversification** – Investment across different securities.
- **Professional Management** – Managed by qualified fund managers.
- **Flexibility** – Different schemes for different financial goals.
- **Convenience** – Easy investment and monitoring.
- **Systematic Investment** – Facility to invest regularly through SIP.
- **Mutual funds are market**-linked investments, so their value may fluctuate.

## 1.4 Types of Mutual Funds

**Mutual funds are classified according to their investment objectives and asset allocation.**

- **Equity Funds** – Mainly invest in equity shares.
- **Debt Funds** – Mainly invest in bonds and fixed-income securities.

- **Hybrid Funds** – Combine equity and debt investments.
- **Index Funds** – Aim to track a selected market index.
- **ELSS** – An equity-oriented mutual fund category with applicable tax benefits.

## 1.5 Mutual Fund Investment Process

The investment process involves selecting a suitable scheme and making an investment according to the investor's financial objective.

Basic Process

KYC → Scheme Selection → Investment → Unit Allocation → Monitoring → Redemption

The investor completes the required KYC process, selects a scheme, invests through an appropriate method and receives units based on the applicable NAV and transaction rules.

## 1.6 Methods of Investment

### Systematic Investment Plan (SIP)

SIP allows investors to invest a fixed amount at regular intervals. It promotes disciplined and systematic investing.

### Lump-Sum Investment

A lump-sum investment involves investing a larger amount at one time.

| SIP | LUMP SUM |
|---|---|
| Regular Investment | One-Time Investment |
| Fixed Amount | Large Amount At One Time |
| Encourages Discipline | Suitable When Funds Are Available |

## 1.7 Mutual Fund Transactions

Mutual fund transactions are activities performed by investors in relation to their mutual fund units.

- **Purchase** – Buying units.
- **Additional Investment** – Investing more in an existing scheme.

- **Redemption** – Selling units and withdrawing the investment.
- **Switch** – Moving investment from one scheme to another, subject to applicable conditions.
- **SIP** – Making investments at regular intervals.

## 1.8 Net Asset Value (NAV)

**NAV** – Net Asset Value represents the value of one unit of a mutual fund scheme.

It is an important factor in the purchase and redemption of mutual fund units.

**NAV = Net Value of Scheme Assets ÷ Number of Outstanding Units**

NAV changes according to the value of the securities held by the scheme and other applicable factors.

## 1.9 National Stock Exchange of India (NSE)

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) is one of India's major stock exchanges. It provides an electronic and organised platform for activities in the securities market.

**NSE contributes to:**

- ⇨ Electronic trading
- ⇨ Price discovery
- ⇨ Market liquidity
- ⇨ Transparency
- ⇨ Market information
- ⇨ Efficient market infrastructure

## 1.10 Role of NSE in the Financial Market

NSE connects investors and market participants through an organised electronic market.

Its important functions include price discovery, liquidity, transparency and access to market information.

NSE has also contributed to the development of a technology-driven securities market in India.

## 1.11 NSE and Mutual Fund Transactions

Technology-based financial infrastructure has made mutual fund transactions more convenient and efficient.

Mutual fund activities such as purchase, redemption and switching can be carried out through authorised investment channels and platforms.

NSE is particularly relevant to this study because NIFTY 50 represents companies listed on NSE.

## 1.12 Understanding NIFTY 50

NIFTY 50 is a major stock market index representing 50 large and liquid companies listed on NSE.

It provides an indication of the general movement of major companies in the Indian equity market.

NIFTY 50 is widely followed by investors, analysts, fund managers and financial institutions.

**NIFTY 50 is an index, not a mutual fund.**

## 1.13 NIFTY 50 as a Benchmark

A benchmark is a standard used to compare investment performance.

NIFTY 50 is widely used as a benchmark for large-cap Indian equities. It helps investors understand how an investment performs compared with a relevant market reference.

However, investors should also consider **risk, cost, investment objective and investment period** while evaluating a mutual fund.

## 1.14 NIFTY 50 and Index Mutual Funds

An index mutual fund aims to track the performance of a particular market index.

A NIFTY 50 index fund seeks to closely follow the performance of NIFTY 50, subject to expenses and tracking differences.

**Simple Relationship**

**NIFTY 50 → Index → Index Fund → Investor**

This makes NIFTY 50 an important concept when studying index-oriented mutual fund investments.

## 1.15 Market Performance

Market performance refers to the movement of securities and market indices over a particular period.

**It can be influenced by:**

- ✓ Economic conditions
- ✓ Inflation
- ✓ Interest rates
- ✓ Corporate performance
- ✓ Government policies
- ✓ Global events
- ✓ Investor sentiment

Changes in market conditions can affect equity prices and the value of equity-oriented mutual funds.

## 1.16 Risk and Return

**Risk** is the possibility of variation in expected investment returns. **Return** represents the gain or loss generated from an investment.

Mutual fund investments are subject to market risks, and different fund categories carry different levels of risk.

**Therefore, investors should consider:**

**Financial Goal + Risk Tolerance + Investment Period + Suitable Scheme**

## 1.17 Investor Awareness

Investor awareness means having sufficient knowledge to make informed investment decisions.

**An investor should understand:**

Mutual Funds • NAV • SIP • Risk • Return • Diversification • NIFTY 50 • Index Funds

Awareness helps investors evaluate investment opportunities and understand the risks associated with market-linked investments.

## 1.18 Diversification

Diversification means spreading investments across different securities, companies or sectors.

For example, a mutual fund may invest in several companies instead of investing the entire amount in one company.

**Diversification → Reduced Concentration → Better Portfolio Management**

However, diversification does not completely eliminate investment risk.

## 1.19 Investor Preferences

Investors may differ in their preferences based on their **income, financial goals, risk tolerance, investment period and market knowledge.**

Some investors may prefer SIP for regular investment, while others may prefer lump-sum investment. Similarly, investors may select equity, debt, hybrid or index funds according to their individual requirements.

Understanding these preferences is an important part of studying investor behaviour.

## 1.20 Importance of the Study

The present study focuses on the relationship between **mutual funds, NSE and NIFTY 50**, along with investment practices and investor awareness.

**The study helps to understand**:

1. The concept of mutual funds.

2. The mutual fund transaction process.

3. The role of NSE.

4. The importance of NIFTY 50.

5. NIFTY 50 index funds.

6. Market performance.

7. Investor awareness.

8. Investor preferences.

9. SIP and lump-sum investments.

10. Benefits and risks of mutual fund investment.

## 1.21 Conceptual Framework

The study can be understood through the following investment relationship:

Investor
↓
Investment Decision
↓
Mutual Fund
↓
Pooled Money
↓
Financial Securities
↓
Market Performance
↓
NIFTY 50 / Benchmark
↓
Investment Value & Returns

**Key Idea**

"Understand the investment, understand the market, and make informed decisions."

# CHAPTER 2
# REVIEW OF LITERATURE

# REVIEW OF LITERATURE

**J. J. Gitman and Michael D. Joehnk (2008)** explained that mutual funds provide investors with diversification by pooling money and investing in a variety of securities.

**Sumathy and Akshaya S. Das (2022)** studied mutual fund investors' awareness and highlighted the importance of investors' knowledge, investment habits and understanding of different mutual fund schemes.

**Aditya Prasad Sahoo (2020)** found that investors consider factors such as safety, profitability and diversification while selecting mutual funds. The study also observed a preference for equity schemes and SIP among many investors.

**Khurana, Chauhan, Babbar, Badlani and Sharma (2026)** found that safety, liquidity, tax benefits, lower risk and higher returns influence investors' perception towards mutual funds.

**Shreya Shrikant Kelkar and Shiva M. Padme (2026)** reviewed mutual fund investment behaviour among salaried individuals and highlighted the importance of financial literacy, risk perception and long-term investment practices.

**P. Revathi (2026)** observed that investor decisions are influenced by risk perception, investment knowledge, liquidity, financial goals and expected returns. The study also highlighted diversification and professional management as important attractions of mutual funds.

**Sahoo (2020)** observed that investors often depend on fund managers and brokers for investment decisions and may not fully analyse the risks associated with mutual fund investments.

**Sumathy and Akshaya S. Das (2022)** highlighted that understanding mutual funds, investment habits and awareness of different schemes are important factors in improving investor participation.

**K. S. [Study on Mutual Fund Investor Behaviour] (2018)** examined information-search behaviour among Indian mutual fund investors and found that investors' knowledge and perception influence the way they search for information and select mutual funds.

**Manas Kumar Kushwaha (2026)** studied SIP contributions and mutual fund growth in India and highlighted SIP as an important tool for disciplined, long-term investment.

**Pushti B. Gajera and Dr. Taral Patel (2026)** found that mutual fund investors are influenced by financial planning, risk perception, social influence and investment goals, with a preference for systematic investment practices such as SIP.

**Bhandari, Attar and Dhakane (2026)** studied retail investor behaviour towards bank-sponsored mutual funds and SIPs and examined the factors influencing investment decisions in semi-urban India.

**Sachin and Amit Yadav (2026)** examined behavioural biases in mutual fund investments and highlighted factors such as herding behaviour, recency bias, overconfidence, SIP behaviour and loss aversion.

**Mukta Rani Hessa and Amar Kumar Chaudhary (2026)** observed that digital investment platforms and growing financial awareness are encouraging self-directed mutual fund investing among young Indian investors.

**Dr. Suhas D and Divya M. C. (2026)** highlighted that mutual fund investment decisions are influenced by risk perception, return expectations, financial knowledge, income and investment objectives.

**Kritika Khurana et al. (2026)** observed that investors continue to require better awareness of the advantages and limitations of mutual funds while making investment decisions.

**Kelkar and Padme (2026)** highlighted that salaried investors increasingly consider mutual funds for long-term financial objectives, particularly through systematic investment approaches.

**Gajera and Patel (2026)** found that behavioural factors, financial planning and risk perception have an important influence on mutual fund investment preferences.

**Sachin and Amit Yadav (2026)** emphasised that psychological factors can influence mutual fund investment decisions and may cause investors to deviate from purely rational investment behaviour.

**Present Study**: Based on the above literature, the present study focuses specifically on mutual fund transactions through NSE with special reference to NIFTY 50, covering investment process, market performance, investor preferences and investor awareness

# CHAPTER 3

# PROFILE OF NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA NSE

# INTRODUCTION

A mutual fund is a professionally managed investment vehicle that pools money from multiple investors and invests it in a diversified portfolio of securities such as equity shares, bonds, government securities, and money-market instruments. It enables investors to participate in financial markets with the benefit of diversification and professional management.

In India, the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) plays a significant role in the financial market and provides platforms and infrastructure that support mutual fund transactions and investment activities.

For equity-oriented mutual funds, the NIFTY 50 is an important market benchmark. It represents 50 large and liquid companies listed on the NSE and is widely used to understand and track the overall movement and performance of the Indian equity market.

## 🖌️ A Simple Way to Understand Mutual Funds

A mutual fund can be compared to a cricket team. Just as several players come together to form a strong team and work towards a common goal, many investors pool their money into a mutual fund. The fund manager acts like the captain, making investment decisions and managing the portfolio across different securities.

## Investment Flow

**Investors → Pool of Funds → Mutual Fund → Diversified Securities → Market Performance → Returns**

Thus, mutual funds provide investors with a structured approach to investing by combining pooled resources, diversification, professional management, and market participation.

# ABOUT NSE

National Stock Exchange of India

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) is one of India's major stock exchanges and an important part of the country's financial market. It provides a modern electronic trading platform and market infrastructure for various financial products.

## 📌 Major Market Segments

- **Equity** – Buying and selling of company shares
- **Equity Derivatives** – Futures and options based on shares and indices

- **Currency Derivatives** – Trading in currency-related contracts
- **Debt Securities** – Trading in bonds and other debt instruments
- **Mutual Funds** – Facilities supporting mutual fund transactions
- **Market Indices** – Indices such as NIFTY 50 that track market performance

Interesting Example:

Think of NSE as a digital marketplace.
Just like a marketplace connects buyers and sellers, NSE provides an electronic platform that connects investors and market participants for financial transactions.

For example, when an investor wants to buy shares of a company listed on NSE, the order can be placed electronically through a broker and matched with a suitable seller.
Investor → Broker → NSE Platform → Transaction → Investment

In simple words:

NSE acts as a bridge between investors and the financial market, making trading more organized, transparent, and efficient.

## WHAT IS A MUTUAL FUND?

A mutual fund is an investment vehicle that collects money from many investors and pools it into a common fund. The pooled money is then professionally managed by an Asset Management Company (AMC) and invested in a portfolio of securities according to the scheme's investment objective.

Easy Example: **Think of a Team Game**

Imagine 1,000 players joining a team game. Each player contributes ₹1,000.
1,000 Investors × ₹1,000 = ₹10,00,000
Instead of each player managing everything individually, the team captain (Fund Manager) decides how the team's resources should be used to achieve the common goal.
Similarly, a mutual fund combines investors' money and invests it across different securities.

🏏 Mutual Fund as a Cricket Team
👥 Investors → Team Players
💰 Pooled Money → Team Resources
👨‍💼 Fund Manager → Team Captain
📊 Different Securities → Different Players
🎯 Investment Objective → Team Goal
📈 Returns / Losses → Match Result

## Mutual Fund Structure:

Investors
↓
Mutual Fund Scheme
↓
Asset Management Company (AMC)
↓
Portfolio of Securities
↓
Returns / Losses
↓
Investors

## In One Line

"Many investors, one pooled fund, professional management, and diversified investments working towards a common financial objective."

## WHAT IS NIFTY 50?

A Snapshot of India's Equity Market
NIFTY 50 is a major stock market index consisting of 50 large and liquid companies listed on the NSE. It is widely used as a benchmark to track the performance and movement of the Indian equity market.

## WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

- Market Indicator – Shows the general direction of the market.
- Performance Benchmark – Helps compare investment performance.
- Large Companies – Represents major companies across sectors.
- Market Trends – Helps study equity market movements.
- Investment Reference – Used by index funds and ETFs.

EASY EXAMPLE:

Think of NIFTY 50 like a cricket team scoreboard.
Instead of checking every player separately, the scoreboard gives a quick idea of the team's overall performance.

50 Companies → 1 Index → Market Performance

REMEMBER

NIFTY 50 = Index, NOT a Mutual Fund.

You cannot directly invest in the index, but NIFTY 50 index funds and ETFs can track its performance.

## 🔗 CONNECTION BETWEEN NSE, NIFTY 50 & MUTUAL FUNDS

The NSE, NIFTY 50, and mutual funds are closely connected in the investment ecosystem.

NSE → NIFTY 50 → MUTUAL FUND

NSE
The Market Platform
⬇️
NIFTY 50
The Market Benchmark
⬇️
Index Mutual Fund / ETF
Tracks the NIFTY 50
⬇️
Investor
Invests through the financial product

EASY EXAMPLE

Think of NSE as the stadium, NIFTY 50 as the scoreboard, and an index mutual fund as the team following the scoreboard's performance.

For example, an investor can choose a NIFTY 50 Index Mutual Fund, which aims to track the performance of the NIFTY 50, although returns may differ slightly due to expenses and tracking differences.

**KEY IDEA**

NSE provides the market → NIFTY 50 measures market performance → Index funds help investors participate in that market performance.

## MUTUAL FUND TRANSACTIONS

Four Simple Ways Investors Manage Their Investments

Mutual fund transactions are the basic activities through which investors enter, manage, and exit a mutual fund investment.

1. **PURCHASE** — "Start Investing"

The investor puts money into a mutual fund scheme and receives units based on the applicable NAV.

Money → Mutual Fund → Units

2. **REDEMPTION** — "Withdraw Investment"

The investor redeems units according to the scheme's terms and receives the applicable amount.

Units → Redemption → Money

3. **SWITCH** — "Move Investment"

The investor transfers an investment from one mutual fund scheme to another, subject to applicable conditions.

Scheme A → Switch → Scheme B

4. **SIP** — "Invest Regularly"

A Systematic Investment Plan (SIP) allows an investor to invest a predetermined amount at regular intervals.

Regular Investment → Units → Portfolio Building

**EASY WAY TO REMEMBER**

PURCHASE = Enter
SIP = Build
SWITCH = Move
REDEMPTION = Exit

"Invest smartly, stay consistent, and understand every transaction before investing."

## MUTUAL FUND TRANSACTION THROUGH NSE

A Digital Investment Journey

A mutual fund transaction can be understood as a simple journey where an investor's request moves through the required digital and financial infrastructure before the investment is completed.

**THE INVESTMENT JOURNEY**

01 — INVESTOR
Decides to invest or redeem.

⬇
02 — KYC READY
Investor completes the required KYC and account setup.

⬇

03 — CHOOSE
Selects a suitable mutual fund scheme.

⬇

04 — TRANSACT
Submits the purchase, SIP, switch, or redemption request.

⬇

05 — PROCESS
The transaction moves through the relevant NSE-supported infrastructure and intermediary.

⬇

06 — AMC ACTION
The mutual fund/AMC processes the transaction.

⬇

07 — CONFIRM
Units are allotted or redemption is processed, followed by transaction confirmation.

EASY EXAMPLE

Think of it like ordering a product online:

You place the order → Digital system processes it → Seller receives it → Order is completed → Confirmation arrives.

Similarly:

Investor Request → Digital Infrastructure → AMC Processing → Units / Money → Confirmation

**KEY TAKEAWAY**

NSE-related infrastructure helps connect the investor's transaction request with the appropriate mutual fund processing system, making the transaction journey structured and efficient.

The exact process may differ based on the NSE facility, intermediary, AMC, and transaction type.

## NIFTY 50 INDEX FUND

One Basket. One Benchmark. Many Companies.

A NIFTY 50 Index Fund is a mutual fund designed to track the performance of the NIFTY 50 Index. It invests in the companies represented in the index rather than relying mainly on active stock selection.

THINK OF IT AS A READY-MADE BASKET

Imagine a basket containing shares representing the NIFTY 50 companies.

Instead of choosing individual shares yourself, the index fund provides a single investment route to a diversified portfolio that follows the NIFTY 50.

NIFTY 50 Index
⬇
50 Companies
⬇
Index Fund Basket
⬇
Investor

## WHAT IS THE AIM?

The fund generally aims to deliver returns that closely correspond to the NIFTY 50's performance, before expenses and subject to tracking error.

REMEMBER

NIFTY 50 = Benchmark
Index Fund = Fund that follows the benchmark

Simple idea:

“One investment can give you exposure to a basket designed to follow 50 major companies”

# NIFTY 50 & MUTUAL FUND PERFORMANCE

Benchmark • Compare • Understand

The NIFTY 50 serves as an important benchmark for evaluating certain equity mutual funds. It provides a reference point to understand whether a fund has performed in line with, above, or below the selected market benchmark.

## MAIN POINTS

Factor| Meaning

- NIFTY 50| Market benchmark
- NAV| Value of one mutual fund unit
- Fund Return| Return generated by the fund
- Benchmark Return| Return generated by NIFTY 50
- Tracking Error| Difference between an index fund/ETF and its benchmark

EXAMPLE

**Suppose:**

NIFTY 50 → 10% Return
Index Fund → 9.7% Return

The difference may arise from fund expenses and tracking error.**WHY RETURNS MAY DIFFER**

A mutual fund’s return does not automatically equal the NIFTY 50 return. Differences can occur due to:

Portfolio Composition • Fund Expenses • Tracking Error • Cash Holdings • Market Conditions • Investment Strategy

FORMULA:

Benchmark → Compare → Measure → Understand

## KEY TAKEAWAY

“NIFTY 50 provides the yardstick; mutual fund performance shows how the investment measures against it”

## TYPES OF MUTUAL FUNDS

One Market • Different Investment Choices

Mutual funds are designed for different risk levels, financial goals, and investment preferences. Think of them as different routes to reach your financial destination.

- Type| Main Focus| Simple Idea
- Equity Fund| Company shares| Growth
- Debt Fund| Fixed-income securities| Income & Stability
- Hybrid Fund| Equity + Debt| Balance
- Index Fund| Market index| Track the Market
- ELSS| Equity + tax-related features| Tax-related Benefit

## THINK OF IT AS A JOURNEY

1. Want growth? → Equity Fund
2. Prefer fixed-income investments? → Debt Fund
3. Want a combination? → Hybrid Fund
4. Want to follow NIFTY 50? → Index Fun
5. Looking for an equity-linked tax-saving option? → ELSS

## KEY POINT

Each fund type has its own risk, return potential, features, and suitability. The right choice depends on the investor's financial goal, risk tolerance, and investment horizon.

"Choose the fund that matches your goal—not simply the fund that sounds attractive"

## BENEFITS OF MUTUAL FUND INVESTMENT

Simple Investing • Professional Management • Diversification

Mutual funds offer investors a convenient way to participate in financial markets through professionally managed and diversified portfolios.

1. **DIVERSIFICATION** — "Don't Put All Your Eggs in One Basket"

Money can be spread across different securities, which can help reduce dependence on a single investment.

2. **PROFESSIONAL MANAGEMENT** — "Experts Manage the Portfolio"

The fund is managed according to the scheme's investment objective and strategy.

3. **FLEXIBLE INVESTMENT** — "Invest Your Way"

Depending on the scheme, investors may choose options such as lump-sum investment or SIP.

4. **TRANSPARENCY** — "Know Your Investment"

Investors can access information such as NAV, scheme details, and portfolio disclosures.

5. **MARKET PARTICIPATION** — "Join the Market"

Equity mutual funds provide a convenient way to participate indirectly in equity markets.

**EASY WAY TO REMEMBER**

**Diversify → Manage → Invest → Monitor → Participate**

"Mutual funds bring diversification and professional management together in one investment approach"

## MUTUAL FUND RISKS

Every Investment Has a Risk — Know It Before You Invest

Mutual funds are market-linked investments. Their value can rise or fall with market conditions, and returns are generally not guaranteed.

**THE RISK MAP**

- ⇨ **Market Risk**
  Overall market movements can affect investment value.

- ⇨ **Equity Risk**
  Share prices may fluctuate and affect equity investments.

- ⇨ **Interest-Rate Risk**
  Changes in interest rates can impact debt investments.

⇨ **Credit Risk**
An issuer may fail or delay in meeting its financial obligations.

⇨ **Liquidity Risk**
Some securities may not be easily sold when required.

⇨ **Tracking Error**
An index fund or ETF may not exactly match its benchmark's performance.

⇨ **Scheme-Specific Risk**
Every scheme has risks based on its portfolio and investment strategy.

## THINK OF IT LIKE A JOURNEY

Investment → Market Conditions → Returns / Losses

Just as a journey can have unexpected changes, market conditions can also change. Understanding the risks helps investors make informed decisions.

INVESTOR CHECK

Read → Understand → Compare → Decide

Before investing, review the scheme-related documents and risk factors, and consider whether the investment suits your financial goals and risk tolerance.

## GOLDEN RULE

"Don't invest only for the return. Understand the Risk Before Expecting the Return."

## OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

From Market Knowledge to Investor Insight

This study focuses on understanding the mutual fund ecosystem and exploring how investors interact with different investment options.

## OUR STUDY ROADMAP

01. **BUILD KNOWLEDGE**
Understand the basic concept and functioning of mutual funds.

02. **EXPLORE NSE**
Study the role of NSE and its transaction infrastructure in mutual fund activities.

03. **UNDERSTAND TRANSACTIONS**
Explore Purchase, Redemption, Switch, and SIP.

04. **DISCOVER NIFTY 50**
Understand the importance of NIFTY 50 as a market benchmark.

05. **CONNECT THE DOTS**
Study the relationship between NIFTY 50 and index mutual funds.

06. **MEASURE AWARENESS**
Assess how well investors understand mutual fund investments.

07. **STUDY PREFERENCES**
Identify investor preferences towards different mutual fund schemes.

08. **WEIGH BENEFITS & RISKS**
Understand the advantages, limitations, and major risks involved in mutual fund investment.

## THE BIG PICTURE

**KNOW → EXPLORE → COMPARE → ANALYSE → UNDERSTAND**

“The study moves beyond the basics to understand the market, the investment choices, and the investors behind them”

# CHAPTER 4

# DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

## TABLE 4.1

## AWARENESS OF MUTUAL FUND

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 78 | 78% |
| No | 22 | 22% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

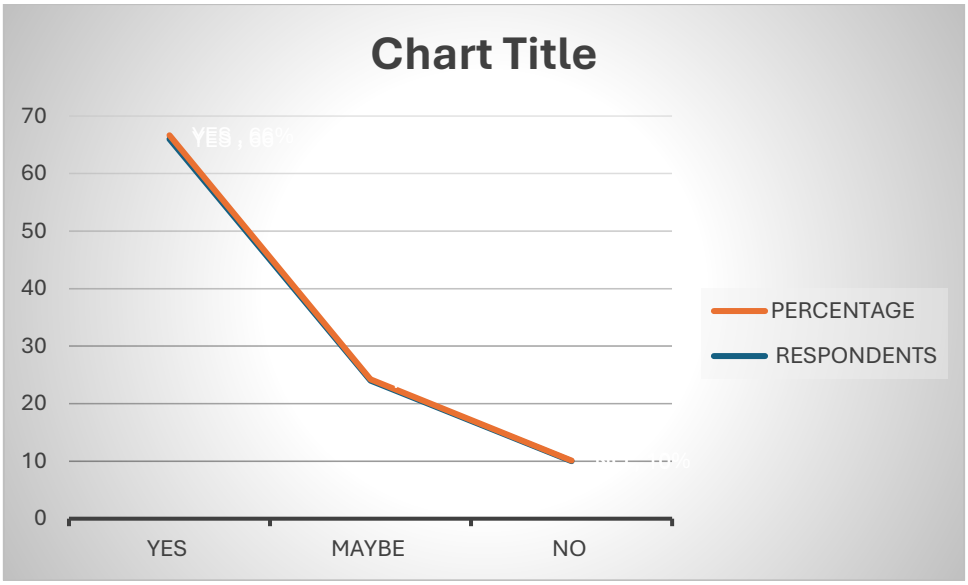
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 78% of respondents are aware of mutual funds, while 22% are not aware. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a good level of awareness about mutual funds.

## CHART 4.1

## AWARENESS OF MUTUAL FUND




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 78% of respondents are aware of mutual funds, while 22% are not aware. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a good level of awareness about mutual funds.

## TABLE 4.2

## INVESTMENT IN MUTUAL FUNDS

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 42 | 42% |
| No | 58 | 58% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

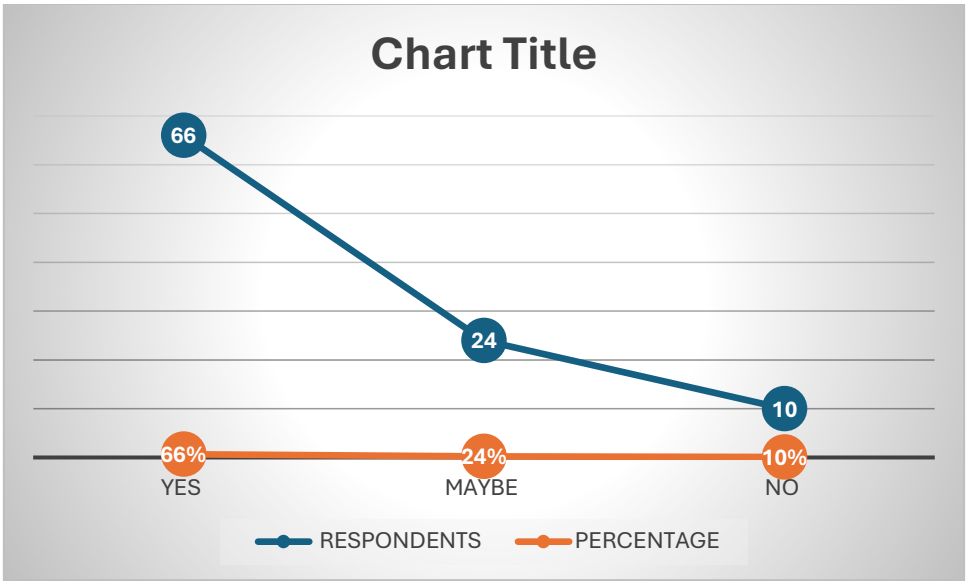
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 42% of respondents have invested in mutual funds, while 58% have not invested. This indicates that although awareness is relatively high, actual investment participation is comparatively low.

## CHART 4.2

## INVESTMENT IN MUTUAL FUNDS




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 42% of respondents have invested in mutual funds, while 58% have not invested. This indicates that although awareness is relatively high, actual investment participation is comparatively low.

## TABLE 4.3

## SOURCE OF MUTUAL FUND AWARENESS

| SOURCE | RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Social Media | 28 | 28% |
| Friends and Family | 24 | 24% |
| College/Education | 20 | 20% |
| Banks/Financial Advisors | 16 | 16% |
| Other Sources | 12 | 12% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

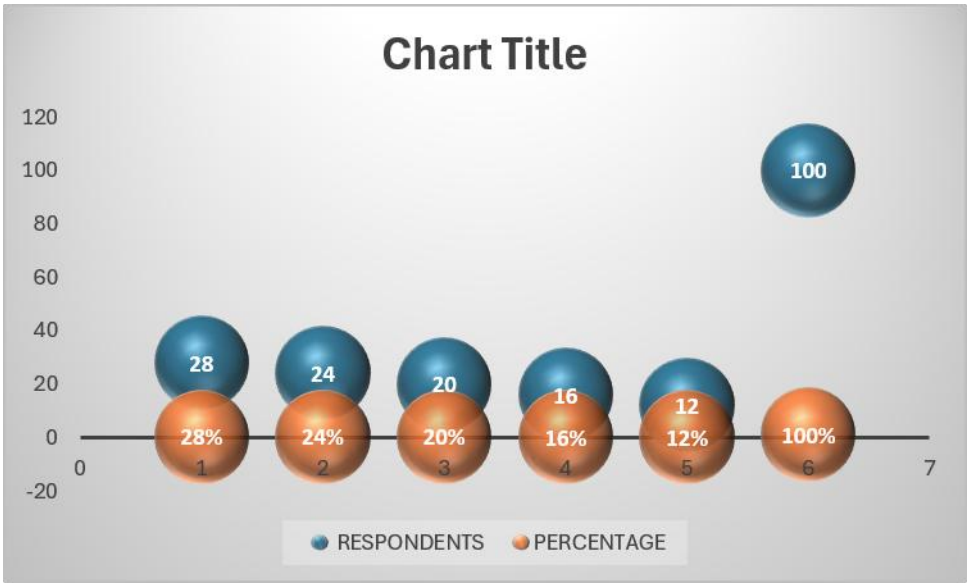
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 28% of respondents gained awareness through social media, followed by 24% through friends and family. College or education contributed 20%, while banks or financial advisors accounted for 16%. This indicates that social media is the major source of mutual fund awareness among respondents.

## CHART 4.3

## SOURCE OF MUTUAL FUND AWARENESS




## Interpretation:

The table shows that 28% of respondents gained awareness through social media, followed by 24% through friends and family. College or education contributed 20%, while banks or financial advisors accounted for 16%. This indicates that social media is the major source of mutual fund awareness among respondents.

## TABLE 4.4

## AWARENESS OF NSE

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 70 | 70% |
| No | 30 | 30% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

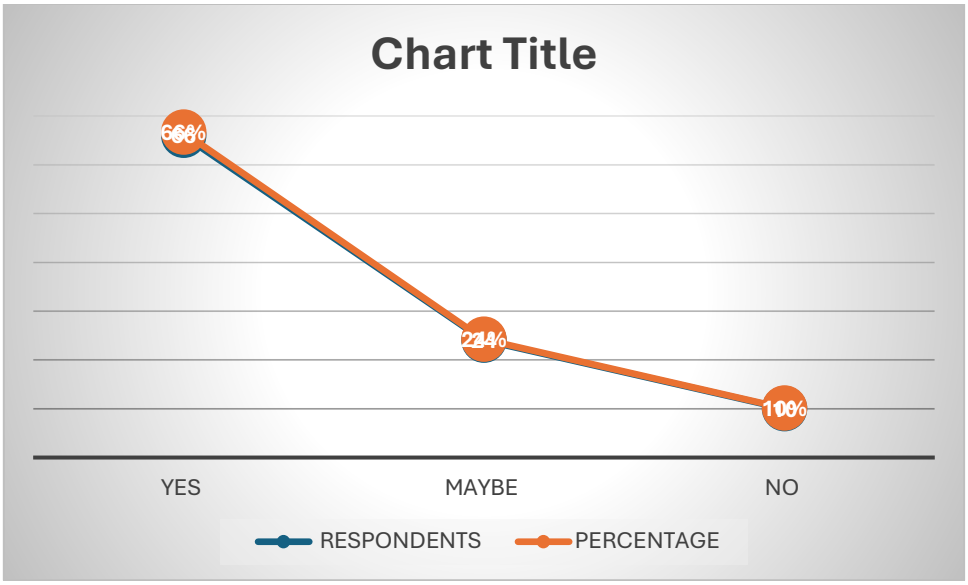
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 70% of respondents are aware of NSE, while 30% are not aware. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a reasonable level of awareness about the National Stock Exchange.

## CHART 4.4

## AWARENESS OF NSE




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 70% of respondents are aware of NSE, while 30% are not aware. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a reasonable level of awareness about the National Stock Exchange.

## TABLE 4.5

## AWARENESS OF NIFTY 50

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 72 | 7% |
| No | 28 | 28% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

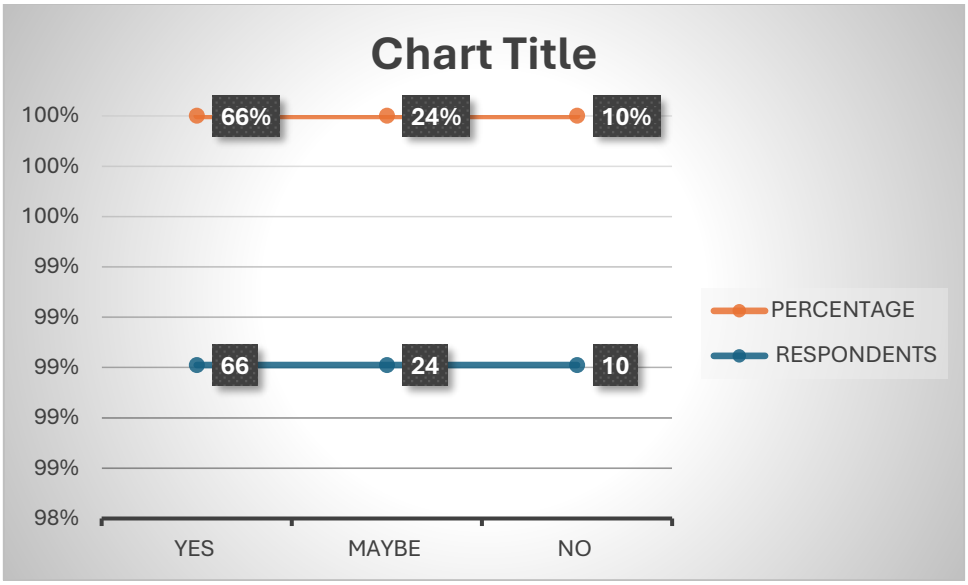
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 72% of respondents are aware of NIFTY 50, while 28% are not aware. This indicates that NIFTY 50 has a good level of recognition among the respondents.

## CHART 4.5

## AWARENESS OF NIFTY 50




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 72% of respondents are aware of NIFTY 50, while 28% are not aware. This indicates that NIFTY 50 has a good level of recognition among the respondents.

## TABLE 4.6

## KNOWLEDGE THAT NIFTY 50 IS AN INDEX

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 60 | 60% |
| No | 40 | 40% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

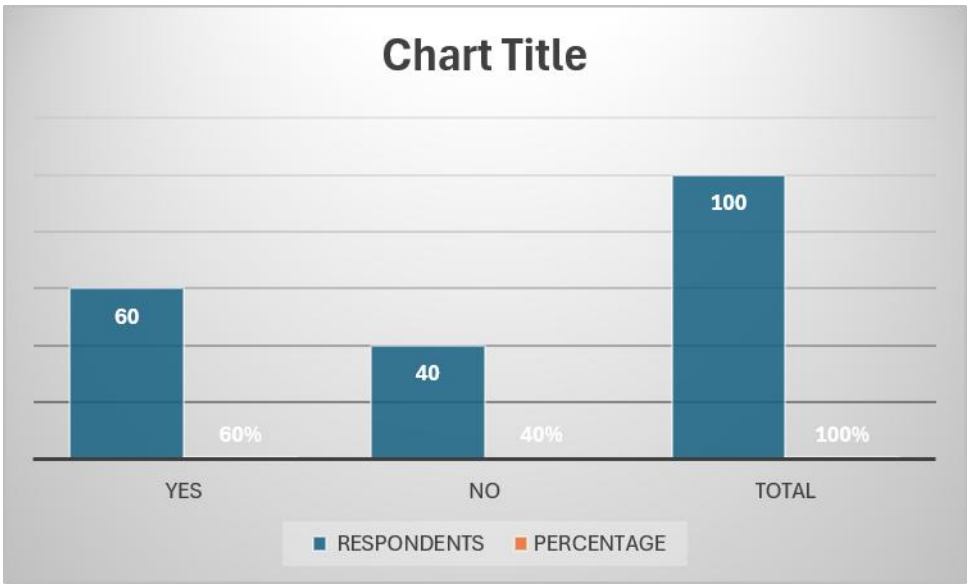
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 60% of respondents know that NIFTY 50 is a market index, while 40% do not have this knowledge. This indicates that although awareness of NIFTY 50 is good, some respondents require better understanding of its role as an index.

## CHART 4.6

## KNOWLEDGE THAT NIFTY 50 IS AN INDEX




## Interpretation:

The table shows that 60% of respondents know that NIFTY 50 is a market index, while 40% do not have this knowledge. This indicates that although awareness of NIFTY 50 is good, some respondents require better understanding of its role as an index.

## TABLE 4.7

## INVESTMENT IN INDEX FUNDS

| Response\| | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 24 | 24% |
| No | 76 | 76% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

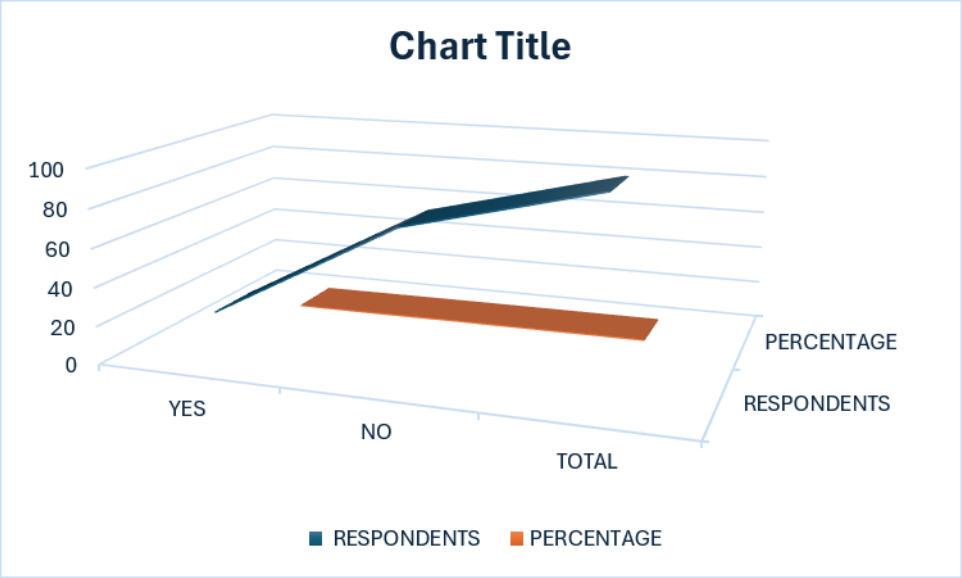
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that only 24% of respondents have invested in index funds, while 76% have not invested. This indicates that participation in index funds is relatively low and there is scope for creating greater awareness about this investment option.

## CHART 4.7

## INVESTMENT IN INDEX FUNDS




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that only 24% of respondents have invested in index funds, while 76% have not invested. This indicates that participation in index funds is relatively low and there is scope for creating greater awareness about this investment option.

## TABLE 4.8

## PREFERRED TYPE OF MUTUAL FUND

| Type of Fund | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Equity Fund | 28 | 28% |
| Debt Fund | 14 | 14% |
| Hybrid Fund | 24 | 24% |
| Index Fund | 22 | 22% |
| ELSS | 12 | 12% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

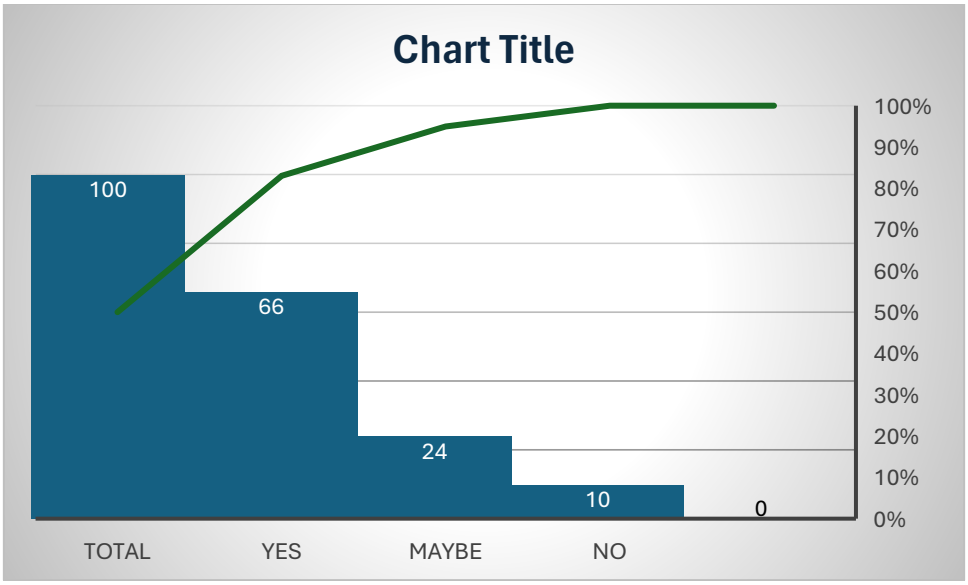
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 28% of respondents prefer equity funds, followed by hybrid funds at 24% and index funds at 22%. Debt funds and ELSS are preferred by 14% and 12% respectively. This indicates that equity funds are the most preferred mutual fund category among respondents.

## CHART 4.8

## PREFERRED TYPE OF MUTUAL FUND




### Interpretation:

The table shows that 28% of respondents prefer equity funds, followed by hybrid funds at 24% and index funds at 22%. Debt funds and ELSS are preferred by 14% and 12% respectively. This indicates that equity funds are the most preferred mutual fund category among respondents.

## TABLE 4.9

## PREFERRED INVESTMENT METHOD

| Investment Method | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| SIP | 54 | 54% |
| Lump Sum | 26 | 26% |
| Both | 20 | 20% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

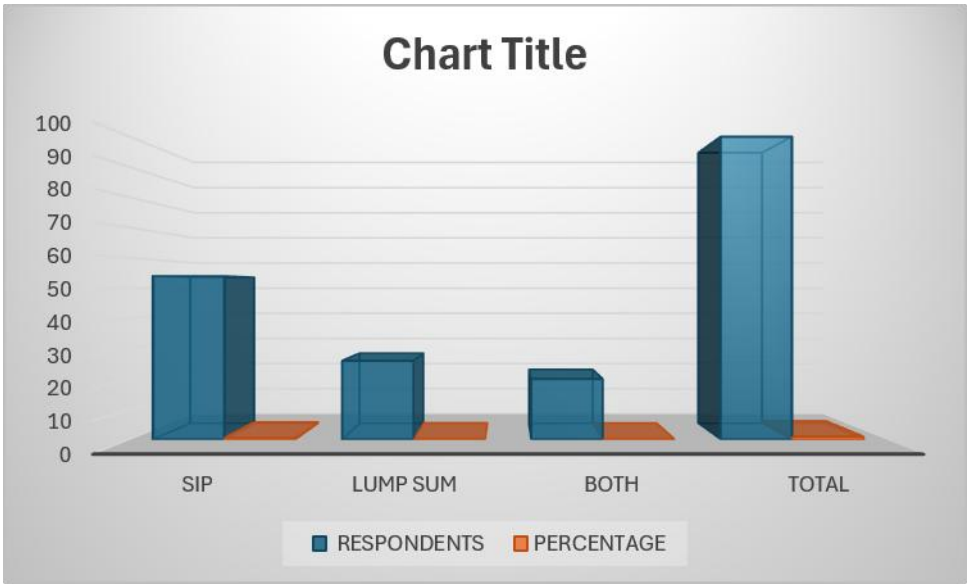
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 54% of respondents prefer SIP, while 26% prefer lump-sum investment and 20% prefer both methods. This indicates that SIP is the most preferred investment method among respondents.

## CHART 4.9

## PREFERRED INVESTMENT METHOD




## Interpretation:

The table shows that 54% of respondents prefer SIP, while 26% prefer lump-sum investment and 20% prefer both methods. This indicates that SIP is the most preferred investment method among respondents.

## TABLE 4.10

## PREFERENCE BETWEEN SIP AND LUMP SUM

| Preference | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| SIP | 62 | 62% |
| Lump Sum | 23 | 23% |
| Both | 15 | 15% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 62% of respondents prefer SIP, while 23% prefer lump-sum investment and 15% prefer both. This indicates that the majority of respondents favour SIP because of its regular and disciplined investment approach.

## CHART 4.10

## PREFERENCE BETWEEN SIP AND LUMP SUM




### Interpretation:

The table shows that 62% of respondents prefer SIP, while 23% prefer lump-sum investment and 15% prefer both. This indicates that the majority of respondents favour SIP because of its regular and disciplined investment approach.

## TABLE 4.11

## MAIN INVESTMENT OBJECTIVE

| Objective | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Wealth Creation | 35 | 35% |
| Regular Savings | 25 | 25% |
| Retirement Planning | 15 | 15% |
| Tax Saving | 13 | 13% |
| Short-Term Goals | 12 | 12% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

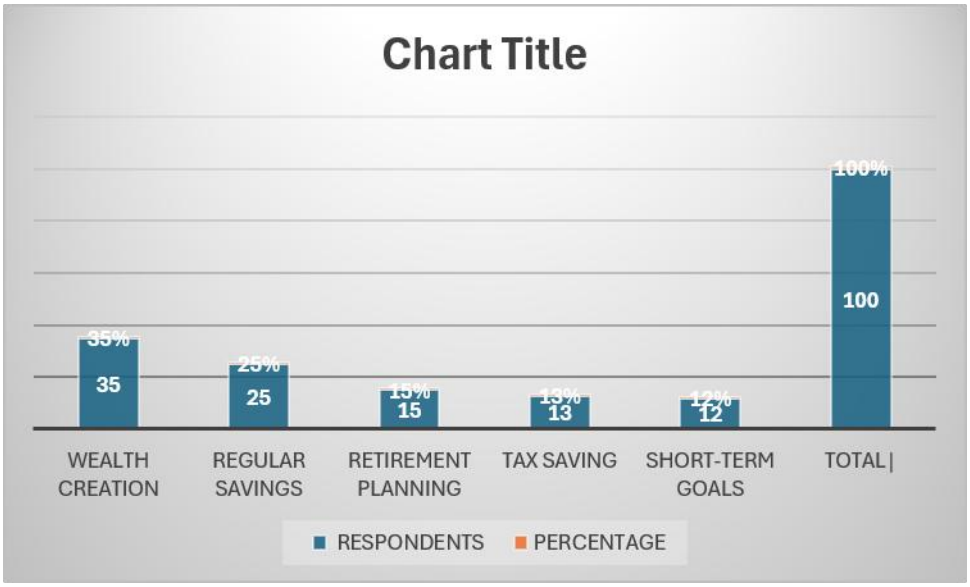
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 35% of respondents invest mainly for wealth creation, followed by 25% for regular savings. Retirement planning, tax saving and short-term goals account for 15%, 13% and 12% respectively. This indicates that wealth creation is the primary investment objective among respondents.

## CHART 4.11

## MAIN INVESTMENT OBJECTIVE




### Interpretation:

The table shows that 35% of respondents invest mainly for wealth creation, followed by 25% for regular savings. Retirement planning, tax saving and short-term goals account for 15%, 13% and 12% respectively. This indicates that wealth creation is the primary investment objective among respondents.

## TABLE 4.12

## INVESTMENT TIME HORIZON

| Period | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Below 3 Years | 18 | 18% |
| 3–5 Years | 28 | 28% |
| 5–10 Years | 34 | 34% |
| Above 10 Years | 20 | 20% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

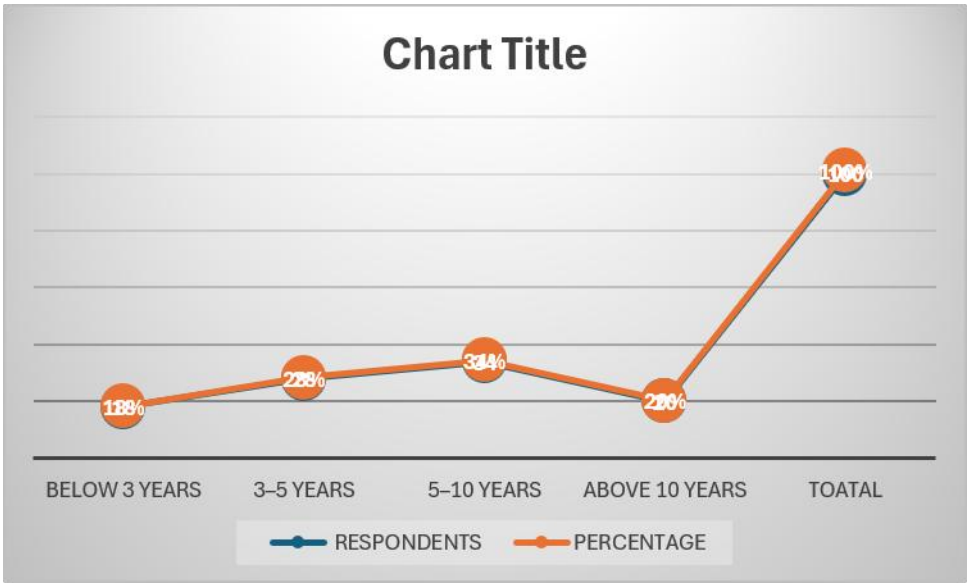
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 34% of respondents prefer an investment period of 5–10 years, while 28% prefer 3–5 years. About 20% prefer more than 10 years and 18% prefer less than 3 years. This indicates that most respondents show a preference for medium- to long-term investment.

## CHART 4.12

## INVESTMENT TIME HORIZON




## Interpretation:

The table shows that 34% of respondents prefer an investment period of 5–10 years, while 28% prefer 3–5 years. About 20% prefer more than 10 years and 18% prefer less than 3 years. This indicates that most respondents show a preference for medium- to long-term investment.

## TABLE 4.13

## RISK PREFERENCE OF INVESTORS

| Risk Level | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Low Risk | 20 | 20% |
| Moderate Risk | 55 | 55% |
| High Risk | 25 | 25% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

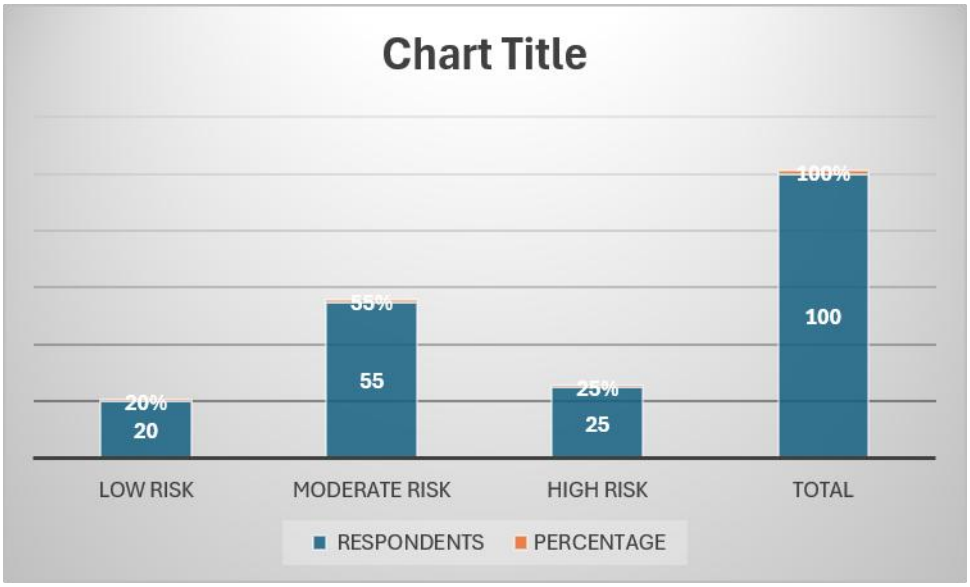
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 55% of respondents prefer moderate risk, while 25% prefer high risk and 20% prefer low risk. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a moderate risk preference while making investment decisions.

## CHART 4.13

## RISK PREFERENCE OF INVESTORS




## Interpretation:

The table shows that 55% of respondents prefer moderate risk, while 25% prefer high risk and 20% prefer low risk. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a moderate risk preference while making investment decisions.

## TABLE 4.14

## AWARENESS OF NAV

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| AWARE | 58 | 58% |
| NOT AWARE | 42 | 42% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 58% of respondents are aware of NAV, while 42% are not aware. This indicates that more than half of the respondents understand NAV, but a considerable number still require better knowledge of this important mutual fund concept.

## CHART 4.14

## AWARENESS OF NAV




### Interpretation:

The table shows that 58% of respondents are aware of NAV, while 42% are not aware. This indicates that more than half of the respondents understand NAV, but a considerable number still require better knowledge of this important mutual fund concept.

## TABLE 4.15

## AWARENESS OF NIFTY 50 AS A BENCHMARK

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| Yes | 64 | 64% |
| No | 36 | 36% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

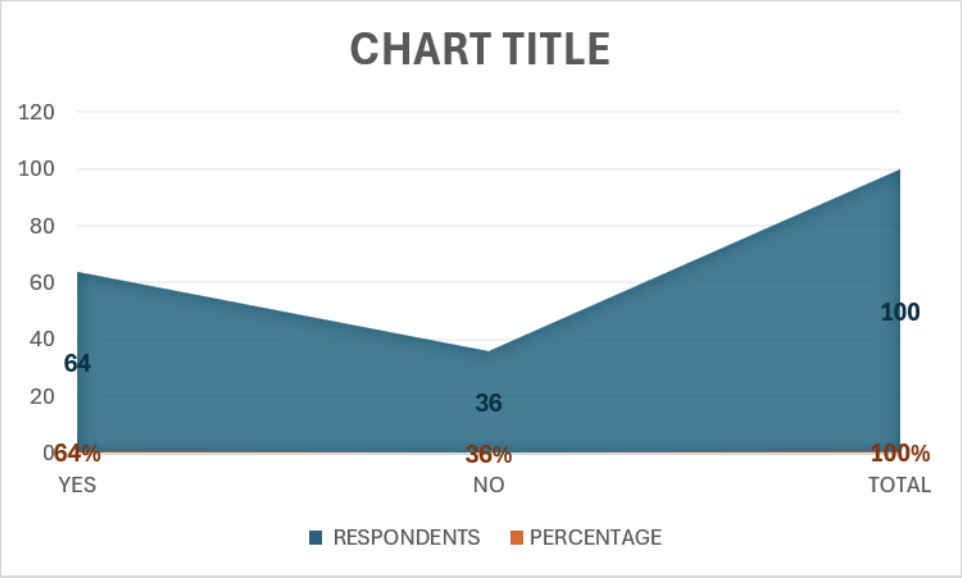
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

Ihe table shows that 64% of respondents know that NIFTY 50 can be used as a benchmark, while 36% are not aware of this. This indicates that the majority understand the importance of NIFTY 50 in evaluating market or fund performance.

## CHART 4. 15

## AWARENESS OF NIFTY 50 AS A BENCHMARK




**Interpretation**:

The table shows that 64% of respondents know that NIFTY 50 can be used as a benchmark, while 36% are not aware of this. This indicates that the majority understand the importance of NIFTY 50 in evaluating market or fund performance.

## TABLE 4.16

## MAJOR CONCERN WHILE INVESTING

| Concern | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Market Risk | 32 | 32% |
| Lack of Knowledge | 24 | 24% |
| Loss of Capital | 20 | 20% |
| Liquidity | 12 | 12% |
| Fees and Expenses | 12 | 12% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

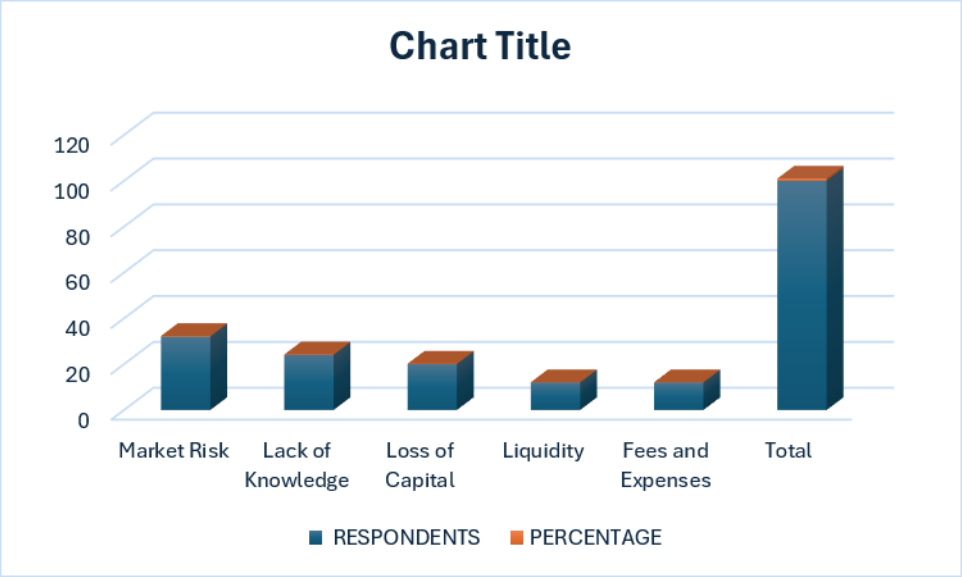
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 32% of respondents consider market risk as their major concern, followed by lack of knowledge at 24% and loss of capital at 20%. Liquidity and fees and expenses account for 12% each. This indicates that market risk is the primary concern among respondents while investing in mutual funds.

## CHART 4.16

## MAJOR CONCERN WHILE INVESTING




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 32% of respondents consider market risk as their major concern, followed by lack of knowledge at 24% and loss of capital at 20%. Liquidity and fees and expenses account for 12% each. This indicates that market risk is the primary concern among respondents while investing in mutual funds.

## TABLE 4.17

## AWARENESS OF DIVERSIFICATION

| RESPONSE | NO. OF RESPONDENTS | PERCENTAGE |
|---|---|---|
| AWARE | 68 | 68% |
| NOT AWARE | 32 | 32% |
| TOTAL | 100 | 100% |

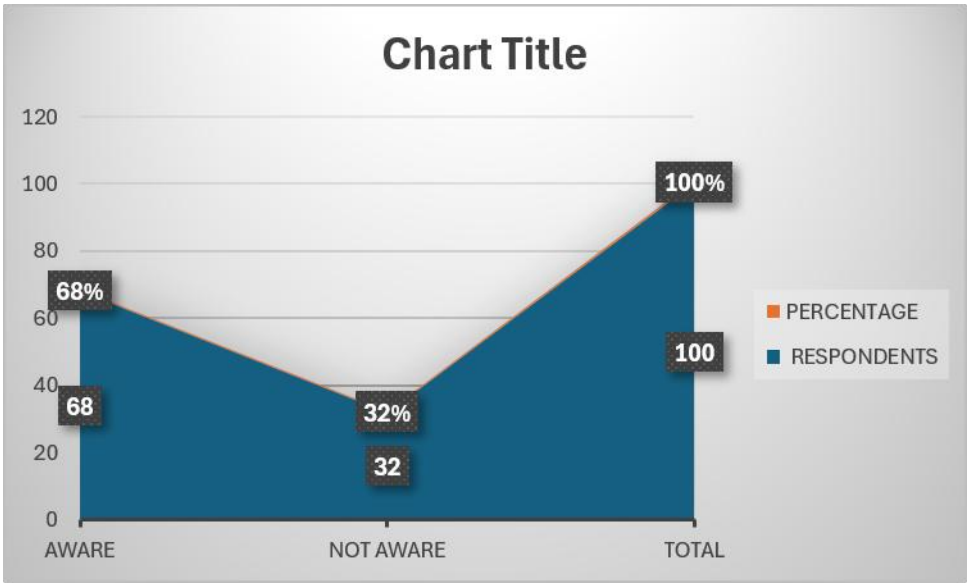
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 68% of respondents are aware of diversification, while 32% are not aware. This indicates that the majority of respondents understand the importance of diversification in mutual fund investment.

## CHART 4.17

## AWARENESS OF DIVERSIFICATION




### Interpretation:

The table shows that 68% of respondents are aware of diversification, while 32% are not aware. This indicates that the majority of respondents understand the importance of diversification in mutual fund investment.

## TABLE 4.18

## AWARENESS OF MUTUAL FUND TRANSACTIONS

| Transaction | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Purchase | 70 | 70% |
| Redemption | 55 | 55% |
| Switch | 38 | 38% |
| SIP | 72 | 72% |

Sources Of Primary Data:

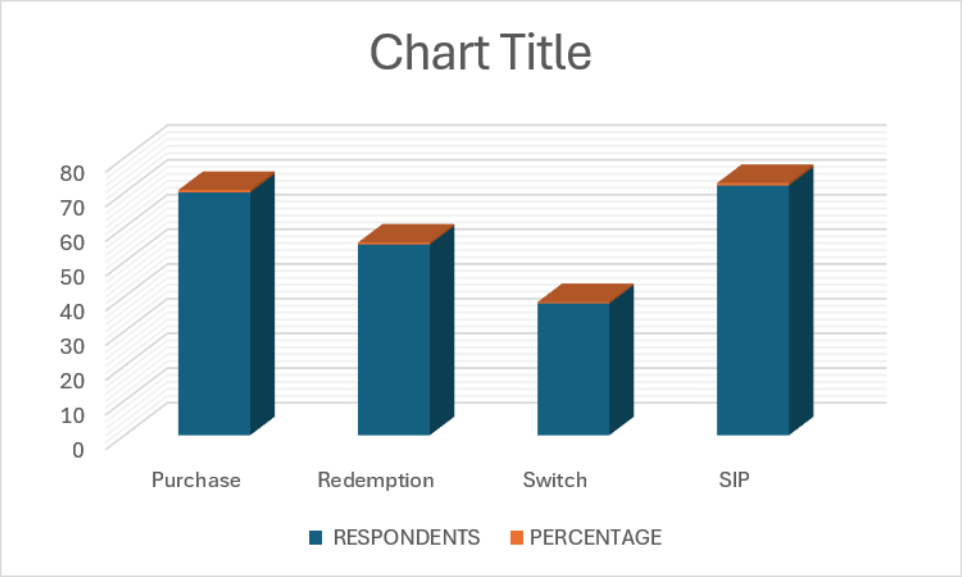
## Interpretation:

The table shows that 72% of respondents are aware of SIP transactions, followed by purchase transactions at 70% and redemption at 55%. Only 38% are aware of switch transactions. This indicates that SIP and purchase are the most familiar mutual fund transactions among respondents, while awareness of switching is comparatively lower.

Note: Multiple responses were permitted; therefore, the total percentage may exceed 100%.

## CHART 4.18

## AWARENESS OF MUTUAL FUND TRANSACTIONS




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 72% of respondents are aware of SIP transactions, followed by purchase transactions at 70% and redemption at 55%. Only 38% are aware of switch transactions. This indicates that SIP and purchase are the most familiar mutual fund transactions among respondents, while awareness of switching is comparatively lower.

Note: Multiple responses were permitted; therefore, the total percentage may exceed 100%.

## TABLE 4.19

## MOST IMPORTANT BENEFIT OF MUTUAL FUNDS

| Benefit | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Diversification | 32 | 32% |
| Professional Management | 24 | 24% |
| Flexible Investment | 18 | 18% |
| Market Participation | 16 | 16% |
| Transparency | 10 | 10% |
| Total | 100 | 100% |

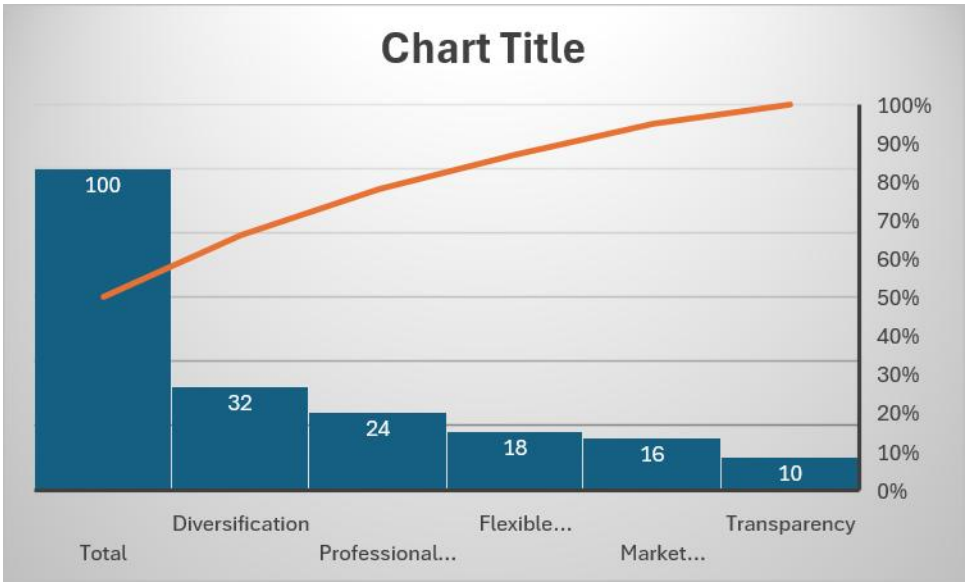
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 32% of respondents consider diversification as the most important benefit, followed by professional management at 24%. Flexible investment, market participation and transparency account for 18%, 16% and 10% respectively. This indicates that diversification is the most valued benefit of mutual funds among respondents.

## CHART 4.19

## MOST IMPORTANT BENEFIT OF MUTUAL FUNDS




### Interpretation:

The table shows that 32% of respondents consider diversification as the most important benefit, followed by professional management at 24%. Flexible investment, market participation and transparency account for 18%, 16% and 10% respectively. This indicates that diversification is the most valued benefit of mutual funds among respondents.

## TABLE 4.20

## FUTURE INVESTMENT INTENTION

| Response | Respondents | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| YES | 66 | 66% |
| MAYBE | 24 | 24% |
| NO | 10 | 10% |
| TOTAL | 100 | 100% |

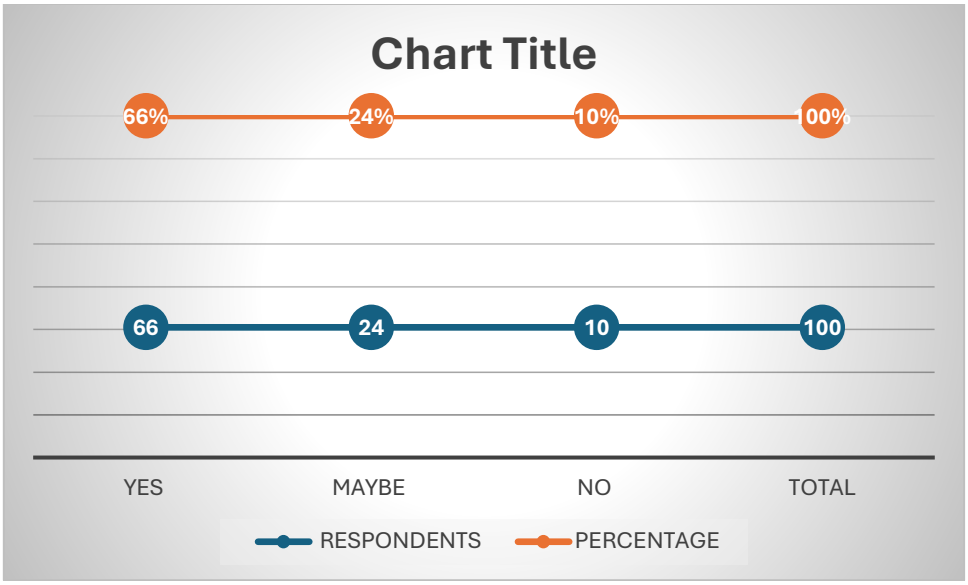
Sources Of Primary Data:

## Interpretation:

The table shows that 66% of respondents intend to invest in mutual funds in the future, while 24% are uncertain and 10% have no intention to invest. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a positive attitude towards future mutual fund investment.

## CHART 4.20

## FUTURE INVESTMENT INTENTION




**Interpretation:**

The table shows that 66% of respondents intend to invest in mutual funds in the future, while 24% are uncertain and 10% have no intention to invest. This indicates that the majority of respondents have a positive attitude towards future mutual fund investment.

# CHAPTER 5

# FINDINGS, SUGGESTION AND CONCLUSION

## FINDINGS

- A majority of respondents are aware of mutual funds, but actual investment participation is comparatively lower.
- Social media is an important source of mutual fund awareness among respondents.
- Most respondents have basic awareness about NSE and NIFTY 50.
- Many respondents understand that NIFTY 50 is a market index, but some need more knowledge about its role and importance.
- Investment in NIFTY 50 index funds is comparatively low among respondents.
- Equity and hybrid funds are among the preferred mutual fund categories.
- SIP is the most preferred investment method, showing interest in regular and disciplined investment.
- Wealth creation is the major investment objective of the respondents.
- Most respondents prefer a moderate level of risk and a medium- to long-term investment period.
- A majority of respondents are aware of NAV and diversification, but further financial education is required.
- NIFTY 50 is recognised as an important benchmark for understanding market performance.
- Market risk and lack of investment knowledge are the major concerns of respondents.
- Respondents have better awareness of purchase and SIP transactions compared with switch transactions.
- Diversification and professional management are considered important benefits of mutual funds.
- A majority of respondents show a positive intention to invest in mutual funds in the future.

- Overall, the study identifies a gap between awareness and actual investment participation.

- The findings highlight the need for greater investor education, risk awareness and understanding of mutual fund transactions.

## SUGGESTIONS

Based on the findings of the study, it is suggested that greater awareness should be created among investors about mutual funds, NSE and NIFTY 50. Investors should be given clear knowledge about important concepts such as NAV, SIP, redemption, switching, diversification, risk and return. Awareness programmes, seminars and financial education activities can help investors make better decisions. Investors should understand their financial goals, investment period and risk level before selecting a mutual fund. More awareness should also be created about NIFTY 50 index funds and their relationship with the NIFTY 50 benchmark. Investors should rely on reliable and regulated sources rather than unverified investment information from social media. Young investors and students should also be encouraged to develop financial knowledge at an early stage.

**Above all, investors should follow the golden rule:**

"Understand the Risk Before Expecting the Return."

## CONCLUSION

The study on "A Study on Mutual Fund Transactions Through NSE with Special Reference to NIFTY 50" concludes that mutual funds are an important investment avenue that provides investors with opportunities for diversification and professional management. The study shows that most respondents have awareness of mutual funds, NSE and NIFTY 50, but actual investment participation is comparatively lower due to factors such as market risk and lack of knowledge. SIP is found to be a preferred investment method, while wealth creation is a major investment objective. NIFTY 50 also plays an important role as a benchmark for understanding market performance. The study highlights the need for better investor education regarding mutual fund transactions, NAV, risk, diversification and index funds. With proper knowledge, disciplined investment and informed decision-making, investors can make more suitable investment choices according to their financial goals and risk capacity. Ultimately, "Understand the Risk Before Expecting the Return" is an important principle for every investor.

# APPENDIX

# BIBLIOGRAPHY

# BIBLIOGRAPHY

## Books & Reference Materials


- Financial Management – Investment planning, risk and return.
- Investment Analysis and Portfolio Management – Investment decisions and portfolio management.
- Financial Services – Mutual funds and financial markets.
- Indian Financial System – Capital market and financial institutions.
- Security Analysis and Portfolio Management – Risk, return and diversification.


## Websites & Official Sources


➪ **SEBI** – Securities and Exchange Board of India

Used for investor education, securities-market information and investor protection.

➪ **NSE India** – National Stock Exchange of India

Used for information related to NSE, market indices and mutual fund transaction facilities.

➪ **NSE Indices** – NIFTY 50

Used for reference on NIFTY 50 and index-related information.

➪ **AMFI** – Association of Mutual Funds in India

Used for mutual fund concepts, types, benefits, risks, NAV and SIP.

➪ **SEBI Investor Education Portal**

Used for investment awareness, market knowledge and safe investment practices.


## Primary Data


- Questionnaire Survey – Primary data collected from respondents.
- Personal Interaction – Information gathered from respondents regarding mutual fund awareness and investment preferences.
- Data Analysis – Questionnaire responses analysed using frequency and percentage methods.


## Key References

- Mutual Fund Investment and Transaction Process
- NIFTY 50 and Index Funds
- Systematic Investment Plan (SIP)
- Net Asset Value (NAV)
- Risk and Return
- Diversification
- Investor Awareness and Financial Education

## Reference Focus:

Mutual Funds • NSE • NIFTY 50 • SIP • NAV • Risk • Return • Diversification • Investor Awareness

# QUESTIONNAIRE

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1. Are you aware of mutual funds?

☐ Yes
☐ No

2. Have you invested in mutual funds?

☐ Yes
☐ No

3. How did you become aware of mutual funds?

☐ Social Media
☐ Friends and Family
☐ College/Education
☐ Banks/Financial Advisors
☐ Other Sources

4. Are you aware of the National Stock Exchange (NSE)?

☐ Yes
☐ No

5. Are you aware of NIFTY 50?

☐ Yes
☐ No

6. Do you know that NIFTY 50 is a market index?

☐ Yes
☐ No

7. Have you invested in an index fund?

☐ Yes
☐ No

8. Which type of mutual fund do you prefer?

☐ Equity Fund
☐ Debt Fund
☐ Hybrid Fund
☐ Index Fund
☐ ELSS

9. What is your preferred investment method?

☐ SIP
☐ Lump Sum
☐ Both

10. Which do you prefer for mutual fund investment?

☐ SIP
☐ Lump Sum
☐ Both

11. What is your main investment objective?

☐ Wealth Creation
☐ Regular Savings
☐ Retirement Planning
☐ Tax Saving
☐ Short-Term Goals

12. What is your preferred investment period?

☐ Below 3 Years
☐ 3–5 Years
☐ 5–10 Years
☐ Above 10 Years

13. What level of investment risk do you prefer?

☐ Low Risk
☐ Moderate Risk
☐ High Risk

14. Are you aware of Net Asset Value (NAV)?

☐ Yes
☐ No

15. Do you know that NIFTY 50 can be used as a benchmark for suitable investment performance?

☐ Yes
☐ No

16. What is your major concern while investing in mutual funds?

☐ Market Risk
☐ Lack of Knowledge
☐ Loss of Capital
☐ Liquidity
☐ Fees and Expenses

17. Are you aware of diversification in mutual fund investment?

☐ Yes
☐ No

18. Which mutual fund transactions are you aware of?

(You may select more than one.)

☐ Purchase
☐ Redemption
☐ Switch
☐ SIP

19. What do you consider the most important benefit of mutual funds?

☐ Diversification
☐ Professional Management
☐ Flexible Investment
☐ Market Participation
☐ Transparency

20. Would you consider investing in mutual funds in the future?

☐ Yes
☐ Maybe
☐ No